language is complete, the Chinese text should be parsed since the agreement is deemed valid in both (or all three languages in case of the Hindi text). It is worth remembering that the Chinese language comes in useful to amend China's commitments when reinterpretation is convenient. In most cases the Chinese character (or word) is more restrictive than its English counterpart and thus each Chinese character has a greater specificity of meaning. Laxity in parsing the Chinese language text at the drafting stage may provide the escape clause for the Chinese side, if and when the situation warrants it. For that reason, where the drafting of agreements with China are concerned, for the opposite side it should be all about the 'letter' and not about the 'spirit' of the text. [11]

In multilateral or international negotiations, in which India and China may be on different sides, China uses a variety of tactics to keep India on the defensive. The easiest route is the one offered by legalized hegemony, for China to assume the mantle of defender of global order, and to defend its core interests by mounting a vigorous defence of the treaty-based world order even though, in many instances, the People's Republic of China became a part of legalized hegemony more by default than by design. [12] This sort of Chinese tactic was seen during the NSG meetings, or even in the discussions about the reform and expansion of the United Nations Security Council. Another favourite tactic is by hiding inside a group. This not only deflects attention and pressure away from China; it allows the Chinese side to claim that there is no consensus. In international negotiations, China is a master of double-speak. Double-speak allows the Chinese to hide within a group of 'like-minded countries', while allowing the other side to hope for a reasonable Chinese posture going forward. The thumb rule in judging the Chinese statements is that the more ambiguous or